MIL-C-13879E (MU)
10 June 1968
SUPERSEDING
MIL-C-13879D (MU)
31 March 1966

MILITARY SPECIFICATION

CHARGE, CRATERING, PARTS FOR AND LOADING, ASSEMBLING AND PACKING

1. SCOPE

1.1 This specification covers special requirements not normally covered by the drawing and provides for quality assurance provisions for one type of explosive charge designated as Charge, Cratering.

2. APPLICABLE DOCUMENTS

2.1 The following documents of the issue in effect on date of invitation for bids, or request for proposals, form a part of this specification to the extent specified herein.

SPECIFICATIONS

FEDERAL

QQ-S-781 - Steel Strapping, Flat

MILITARY

MIL-B-2427 - Boxes, Ammunition, Packing; Wood, Nailed
MIL-A-2550 - Ammunition and Special Weapons; General Specification for
MIL-B-3106 - Board, Composition, Water-Resistant, Solid for Filler or Cushioning Pads
MIL-C-14003 - Cap, Blasting, Special
MIL-C-17124 - Cord, Detonating
MIL-I-45607 - Inspection Equipment, Supply and Maintenance of

FSC: 1375

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STANDARDS

FEDERAL

FED-STD-151 - Metals; Test Methods

MILITARY

MIL-STD-105 - Sampling Procedures and Tables for Inspection by Attributes (ABC-STD-105)
MIL-STD-109 - Quality Assurance Terms and Definitions
MIL-STD-286 - Propellants, Sampling, Inspection and Testing
MIL-STD-1168 - Lot Numbering of Ammunition
MIL-STD-1235 - Single and Multilevel Continuous Sampling Procedures and Tables for Inspection by Attributes

DRAWINGS

U. S. ARMY MUNITIONS COMMAND

8796522 - Marking Diagram and Sealing for Wooden Packing Boxes
8837975 - Charge, Cratering, Assembly, Marking Diagram

PUBLICATIONS

U. S. ARMY MUNITIONS COMMAND

ET - 8837975 - Equipment Tabulation Number

(Copies of specifications, standards, drawings and publications required by contractors in connection with specific procurement functions should be obtained from the procuring activity or as directed by the contracting officer.)

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2.2 Other publications.- The following document forms a part of this specification to the extent specified herein. Unless indicated, the issue in effect on date of invitation for bids shall apply.

CODE OF FEDERAL REGULATIONS

49 CFR 71-90 - Interstate Commerce Commission Rules and Regulations for the Transportation of Explosives and Other Dangerous Articles.

(The Interstate Commerce Commission Regulations are now a part of the Code of Federal Regulations (1949 Edition and revisions) available from the Superintendent of Documents, Government Printing Office, Washington 25, D.C. Orders for the above publication should cite "49 CFR 71-90 (latest revision)".)

3. REQUIREMENTS

3.1 Material.- Materials and parts shall be in accordance with applicable drawings and specifications.

3.2 Assemblies.- The assemblies shall comply with all requirements specified on Drawing (dwg.) 8837975 and with all requirements specified in applicable specifications.

3.3 Moisture content.- The moisture content of each of the explosive compositions shall not exceed 0.20 percent.

3.4 Reactivity of interior coating.- When tested at 100 degrees Centigrade (C.) for stability, the interior coating shall not produce reactivity gas in excess of 3.5 milliliters.

3.5 Waterproofness.- The loaded assembly shall not leak when submerged 1/2 to 3 inches in water and subjected to a vacuum equivalent to 8 inches of mercury for 15 seconds, minimum. Leakage is defined as the presence during test of a stream, or streams, of bubbles of any frequency.

3.6 Functioning.- The loaded assembly shall completely function with detonation initiated by blasting cap or detonating cord.

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3.7 Inertness to impact.- The loaded assembly shall not function from the impact of an M2 .30 caliber round fired at 100 plus or minus two (2) feet from the assembly.

3.8 Workmanship.- All parts and assemblies shall be fabricated and loaded in a thorough, workmanlike manner. They shall be free of burrs, sharp edges, dirt, rust and other foreign matter. The cleaning method used shall not be injurious to any part nor shall the parts be contaminated by the cleaning agent. Exterior surface coatings shall be continuous except for a few light scratches not exposing base material. All required markings shall be neat and sharply defined.

3.9 First article inspection.- This specification makes provisions for first article inspection. Requirements for the submission of first article samples by the contractor shall be as specified in the contract.

4. QUALITY ASSURANCE PROVISIONS

4.1 Responsibility for inspection.- Unless otherwise specified in the contract or purchase order, the supplier is responsible for the performance of all inspection requirements as specified herein. Except as otherwise specified in the contract or order, the supplier may use his own or any other facilities suitable for the performance of the inspection requirements specified herein, unless disapproved by the Government. The Government reserves the right to perform any of the inspections set forth in the specification where such inspections are deemed necessary to assure supplies and services conform to prescribed requirements. Reference shall be made to MIL-STD-109 to define terms used herein. The provisions of MIL-A-2550 shall apply.

4.1.1 Submission of product.- At the time the completed lot of product is submitted to the Government for acceptance the contractor shall supply the following information accompanied by a certificate which attests that the information provided is correct and applicable to the product being submitted:

a. A statement that the lot complies with all quality assurance provisions specified within this specification.

b. Number of units of product inspected.

c. Results obtained, by defect code, for all inspections performed.

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d. Drawing, specification number and date, together with an identification and date of changes.

e. Statement of findings (qualitative and quantitative) on all composition, powder and associated ingredients. Certificates of conformance on all other material purchased by the contractor when such material is controlled by Government or commercial specifications referenced in any of the contractual documents.

f. Number of items in the lot.

g. Date submitted.

The certificate shall be signed by a responsible agent of the certifying organization. The initial certificate submitted shall be substantiated by evidence of the agent's authority to bind his principal. Substantiation of the agent's authority will not be required with subsequent certificates unless, during the course of the contract, this authority is vested in another agent of the certifying organization.

4.2 First article inspection

4.2.1 Submission.- The contractor shall submit a first article sample as designated by the contracting officer for evaluation in accordance with the provisions of 4.2.2. The first article sample shall consist of forty-five (45) charge, cratering assemblies (see 8837975) and five (5) each of every individual component and every sub-assembly, which have been produced by the contractor or furnished by a supplier and which have been manufactured using the same production processes, procedures and equipment which will be used in fulfilling the contract. All parts and materials, including packaging and packing, shall be obtained from the same source of supply as will be used in regular production. Prior to submission, the contractor shall inspect the sample to the degree necessary to assure that it conforms to the requirements of the contract and submit a record of this inspection with the sample, including statement of findings and certificates of conformance for materials (see 4.1.1e). A sample containing known defects will not be submitted unless specifically authorized, by the contracting officer. A first article sample, or portion thereof, as directed by the contracting officer, shall also be submitted whenever there is a lapse in production for a period in excess of 90 days or whenever a change occurs in manufacturing process, material used, drawing or specification such as to significantly affect product uniformity as determined by the Government.

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4.2.2 Inspections to be performed.- Assemblies and components will be subjected by the Government to any or all of the examinations or tests specified in 4.3.2 and 4.3.3 of this specification and any or all requirements of the applicable drawings.

4.2.3 Rejection.- If any assembly or component fails to comply with any of the applicable requirements, the first article sample shall be rejected. The Government reserves the right to terminate its inspection upon any failure of any assembly or component in the sample to comply with any or all of the stated requirements. In the event of rejection the Government reserves the right to require the contractor to take corrective action and submit a new first article sample or portion thereof. Until a first article sample is accepted, the contractor is, in no way, authorized by the Government to initiate regular production unless otherwise directed by the contracting officer.

4.3 Inspection provisions

4.3.1 Lot formation.- The term "lot" as used throughout this specification refers to an inspection lot, which is defined as an essentially homogeneous collection of units of product from which a representative sample is drawn and inspected to determine conformance of the lot with applicable requirements. The sample selected shall represent only that quantity of units from which the sample was drawn and shall not be construed to represent any prior or subsequent quantities presented for inspection. Homogeneity shall be considered to exist provided the lot has been produced by one manufacturer, in one unchanged process, in accordance with the same drawings, same drawing revisions, same specifications and same specification revisions. Changes to the process, specifications, or drawings not affecting safety, performance, interchangeability, or storage, as determined by the Government, shall not be deemed to alter the homogeneity of the lot. Inspection lots shall comply with MIL-STD-105. Unless otherwise approved by the contracting officer the inspection lot size of end items deliverable under the contract shall be not less than the smallest weekly estimate of quantities contractually scheduled for production during the contract period nor more than the largest monthly quantity contractually scheduled for delivery during the contract period. Inspection lots of components or sub-assemblies, other than the items of delivery, shall be homogeneous and of a size mutually convenient to both the contractor and the Government inspector. Lot numbering, as required, shall be in accordance with MIL-STD-1168. Each lot of cratering charges

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shall contain:

a. Parts from not more than one lot number from one manufacturer.

b. Explosive from one batch or blending of batches which results in homogeneity of all explosive used in loading the entire cratering charge lot.

4.3.2 Examinations.- Sampling plans and procedures for the following classifications of defects shall be in accordance with MIL-STD-105 except that inspection for critical defects (and majors, when so specified) shall be 100 percent. Contractor's sampling plans, if used, shall be approved by the Government and shall provide as a minimum, the protection afforded the Government by the sampling plans in MIL-STD-105. Continuous sampling plans in accordance with MIL-STD-1235 for defects other than critical may be used if approved by the procuring activity. Also, at the option of the procuring activity AQL's and sampling plans may be applied to the individual characteristics listed using an AQL of 0.40 percent for each major defect and an AQL of 0.65 percent for each minor defect. Equipment necessary for the performance of the inspections listed shall be in accordance with 4.3.4.

4.3.2.1 Assembly, prior to loading (see dwg. 8837975).

Categories	Defects	Method of Inspection	Code No. (see 6.2)
Critical:	None defined		
Major:	AQL 0.40 percent		
101.	Strength of loop (see 4.4.2)....	Test	01001
102.	Interior coating damaged.....	Visual	01002
Minor:	AQL 2.50 percent		
201.	Length of either tunnel.....	Gage	01004
202.	Height of either tunnel, minimum.	Gage	01005
203.	Location of tunnel.....	Gage	01006
204.	Short tunnel open at both ends..	Visual	01007
205.	Binding post missing or misplaced.....	Visual	01008
206.	Evidence of poor workmanship (see 3.8).....	Visual	01009

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4.3.2.2 Assembly (see dwg. 8837975)

Categories	Defects	Method of Inspection	Code No.
Critical:	None defined		
Major:	AQL 0.40 percent		
101.	Lifting loop missing.....	Visual	02001
Minor:	AQL 1.50 percent		
201.	Weight.....	Scale	02002
202.	Marking missing, misleading or unidentifiable.....	Visual	02004
203.	Evidence of poor workmanship (see 3.8).....	Visual	02005

4.3.2.3 Wood packing box, sealed (see 5.1)

Categories	Defects	Method of Inspection	Code No.
Critical:	None defined		
Major:	AQL 1.00 percent		
101.	Contents exposed.....	Visual	03001
102.	FSC number missing or misleading.....	Visual	03002
103.	Board broken.....	Visual	03003
104.	Contents loose.....	Visual-Manual	03004
105.	Strapping missing, broken or loose.....	Visual-Manual	03005
106.	Hardware missing, broken or loose.....	Visual-Manual	03006

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Minor:	AQL 1.50 percent		
201.	Marking missing, misleading or unidentifiable.....	Visual	03007
202.	Hardware improperly engaged.....	Visual	03008
203.	Strapping improperly engaged....	Visual	03009
204.	Car seal missing, unsealed or improperly positioned.....	Visual-Manual	03010

4.3.3 Testing

4.3.3.1 First article (see 4.2.1).- The sample submitted as the first article sample shall be tested as specified below after being examined for all drawing dimensions and requirements. Rejection and resubmission criteria shall be in accordance with 4.2.3.

4.3.3.1.1 Moisture content (see 3.3) - Code No. 04001.- This determination shall be made on both explosive compositions using an applicable standard analytical procedure. Certified results of the determinations and the method of determination shall be furnished to the Government.

4.3.3.1.2 Container coatings

4.3.3.1.2.1 Corrosion prevention, salt spray test (see dwg. 8837975 and 4.4.7) - Code No. 02007.- After qualification, the contractor shall control processes, to assure compliance to the salt spray requirement at any time.

4.3.3.1.2.2 Reactivity of interior coating (see 3.4 and 4.4.1) - Code No. 05001.

4.3.3.1.3 Waterproofness (see 3.5 and 4.4.3) - Code No. 02006.

4.3.3.1.4 Inertness to impact (see 3.7 and 4.4.6) Code No. 08001.- Fifteen (15) units of the first article sample shall be submitted to this test.

4.3.3.1.5 Functioning with blasting cap (see 3.6 and 4.4.4) - Code No. 06001.- A test sample of fifteen (15) units of the first article sample shall be submitted to this test.

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4.3.3.1.6 Functioning with detonating cord (see 3.6 and 4.4.5) - Code No. 07001.- A test sample of fifteen (15) units of the first article sample shall be submitted to this test.

4.3.3.2 Production testing

4.3.3.2.1 Moisture content (see 3.3) - Major defect - Code No. 04001.- A sample of each explosive charge shall be selected from each eight (8) hours of production and analyzed, using the method utilized in 4.3.3.1.1. Should a sample contain excessive moisture, two (2) additional samples shall be selected from different locations of the production quantity. Failure of any of the two second samples in meeting the requirement shall reject the production represented by the sample.

4.3.3.2.2 Reactivity of interior coating (see 3.4 and 4.4.1) - Major defect - Code No. 05001.- This determination shall be made as specified in 4.4.1 on the product of a new supplier or when a change in coating is to occur. The test shall be performed as specified in 4.4.1, using equipment specified therein. Failure of the sample in meeting the requirement shall reject the product represented.

4.3.3.2.3 Waterproofness (see 3.5) - Major defect - Code No. 02006.- This test shall be performed 100 percent as specified in 4.4.3 using the applicable equipment of 4.3.4. Any unit exhibiting leakage shall be classed defective and removed from the lot.

4.3.3.2.4 Functioning with blasting cap (see 3.6) - Major defect - Code No. 06001.- A sample of ten (10) assemblies from each lot shall be submitted to the test of 4.4.4. Failure of one or more units of the sample to function as required shall reject the lot.

4.3.3.2.5 Functioning with detonating cord (see 3.6) - Major defect - Code No. 07001.- A sample of ten (10) assemblies from each lot shall be submitted to the test of 4.4.5. Failure of one or more units of the sample to function as required shall reject the lot.

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4.3.3.2.6 Control sample.- A control sample of ten (10) assemblies shall be randomly selected from the first lot and from every third lot thereafter by the Government inspector and shall be forwarded to an approved testing facility designated by the contracting officer for bullet impact testing in accordance with 3.7 and 4.4.6. Results of the test will not affect lot acceptance but may be a basis for corrective action in subsequent lots.

4.3.4 Inspection equipment.- Equipment Tabulation Number ET - 8837875 identifies the inspection equipment required to perform the examinations and tests prescribed in this section. The contractor shall design inspection equipment in accordance with the instructions in paragraph 6.3.

4.3.4.1 Government rights to documentation.- Inspection equipment drawings and lists provided and revised in accordance with the requirements of the ET may be used by DOD activities for design, procurement, manufacture, testing, evaluation, production and receiving inspection, overhaul, shipping, storage, identification of stock, ordering and storage of replacement parts, inspection of items at overhaul, general maintenance of equipment, construction, survey and whenever inspection equipment drawings are needed.

4.3.4.2 Supply and maintenance.- Supply and maintenance of the equipment listed in the ET shall be in accordance with MIL-I-45607.

4.3.4.3 Government use of contractor's inspection and test equipment.- The contractor shall make available to the Government all inspection and test equipment necessary for determining conformance with contract requirements. Personnel for operating the equipment, and verification of its accuracy, shall be supplied by the contractor for the performance of examination or test by the Government.

4.4 Test methods and procedures

4.4.1 Reactivity of interior coating.- This determination shall be performed in accordance with Test Method 403.1.1 of MIL-STD-286 except that the paint film sample shall be cut into 1/8 inch, approximate, squares and the charge samples shall be

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pulverized in an agate mortar and to a fineness of approximately 12 mesh. Three heating tubes shall be selected and standardized. A 2.5 gram portion of the coating sample shall be placed in one tube, a 2.5 gram portion of a charge sample shall be placed in another tube and a 5 gram portion of a 50/50 mixture of coating and charge shall be placed in the third tube. The procedure of Method 403.1.1 shall then be followed. Evolution as excessive gas shall class the sample defective.

4.4.2 Strength of lifting loop.- The lid shall be assembled to the applicable test equipment and required static load applied. Observation shall be made for failure of a weld or lifting loop. Either defect shall class a unit defective.

4.4.3 Waterproofness.- The assembly shall be submerged in water within the limits specified, the required vacuum applied and observation for leakage made. Any assembly exhibiting leakage shall be classed defective.

4.4.4 Functioning with blasting cap.- The blasting cap complying type II of MIL-C-14003 shall be placed in the closed end portion of the tunnel and detonated. Observation shall be made for complete detonation of the assembly. Any assembly failing to so function shall be classed defective. In the event no detonation occurs in the assembly, it may be retested. Failure to detonate during the retest shall class the assembly defective.

4.4.5 Functioning with detonating cord.- The detonating cord complying type I, class E of MIL-C-17124 shall be passed through the open end portion of the tunnel. A knot shall be made six inches from one end of the cord and the knot shall be drawn snugly against the tunnel. A blasting cap shall be attached to the other end of the cord and the cord shall be detonated. Rejection and retest criteria shall be as detailed in 4.4.4.

4.4.6 Inertness to impact.- This test shall be conducted with the projectile striking the assembly within 3.5 inches of the centerline normal to the long axis and shall not strike the tunnel or longitudinal seam. Test results shall be forwarded to Picatinny Arsenal, Dover, New Jersey, Attention: SMUPA-ND5.

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4.4.7 Corrosion prevention, salt spray.- The loaded painted item shall be assembled to the applicable test equipment. The criteria for this test shall be in accordance with Method 811.1 of Federal Test Method Standard No. 151. The loaded painted item must withstand 48 hours salt spray test. The crimp (performed by the loading manufacturer) must withstand 8 hours salt spray test. There shall be no evidence of corrosion. The salt spray is to be a 20 percent salt solution.

5. PREPARATION FOR DELIVERY

5.1 Preservation and packing

5.1.1 Level A.- Each cratering charge shall be packed in a wooden box complying with MIL-B-2427, Type I, Class 2, Grade A. Fillers consisting of composition board, MIL-B-3106, Type I or II shall be added to sides, ends and on top of contents as required for a tight pack. Boxes shall be closed and strapped in accordance with instructions contained in the Appendix of the box specification.

5.2 Marking.- The box shall be marked as specified on dwg. 8796522. The descriptive nomenclature shall be "1 Charge Cratering." The ICC nomenclature shall be "Explosive Bomb".

6. NOTES

6.1 Ordering data.- Procurement documents shall specify the following:

a. Title, number and date of this specification.

b. Data cards.- Data cards shall be prepared for each lot in accordance with the information specified in Standard MIL-STD-1167.

6.2 Inspection code numbers.- The five digit code numbers assigned to the inspections herein are to facilitate future data collection and analysis by the Government.

6.3 Inspection equipment.- The contractor shall design inspection equipment as required by the inspection Equipment Lists (EL) referenced on the applicable ET in accordance with the instructions of paragraphs 6.3.1 through 6.3.5.

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6.3.1 Inspection equipment lists (EL).- Inspection equipment lists indicate the availability of inspection equipment designs by showing in the "number" column of the list of inspection equipment (Form SMUPA 1010) the numbers of drawings or Federal Stock numbers of existing equipment designs, or codes as indicated in paragraph 6.3.2. Design action required of the contractor is described in paragraphs 6.3.3 and 6.3.4. The contractor will be required to prepare detailed drawings in accordance with 6.3.4 for all the equipment coded as "Contractor Design" in the number column. These contractor designs must be approved by the Government prior to fabrication or procuring of the equipment. Designs shall be submitted for approval as specified in 6.3.5.

6.3.2 Inspection equipment list codes.- The inspection equipment as defined in 6.3.3 and 6.3.4 will be designated in the EL by the following codes:

CD - Contractor design on controlled contractor format and/or commercial equipment.
MU - Army design, mandatory for use.

6.3.3 Army designs.- Army designs are reflected on detailed drawings which completely depict all the information necessary for the fabrication of the item of inspection equipment. The contractor need provide no design when an Army design is listed for an item of inspection equipment. Army designs fall into two basic classifications; mandatory (designated "MU") and non-mandatory (indicated by drawing or Federal Stock Number). When an inspection equipment list references mandatory Army designs, the contractor shall comply with, and use these designs accordingly. The contractor may, however, in connection with non-mandatory designs, and with the approval of the Government, design alternate inspection equipment or use comparable commercial equipment to facilitate his operations. Such contractor prepared designs or commercial equipment selections must be approved by the Government prior to fabrication or procuring of the equipment. Designs shall be submitted for approval as specified in 6.3.5.

6.3.4 Contractor designs.- Contractor designs are designs of inspection equipment for which the Government has assigned design responsibility to the contractor. Contractor designs shall be supported by detailed drawings which depict all information necessary to completely fabricate, calibrate and operate an

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item of inspection equipment. This requires that the necessary views, dimensions, materials, finish, notes, operating and calibration instructions be properly depicted in accordance with approved practices to the extent that further calculation or clarification will not be required. Unless otherwise specified, contractor designs may be developed on the format the contractor normally employs in his equipment design procedure provided such format reflects the detail and information specified above, subject to the following controls: All submitted contractor designs shall conform to MIL-D-1000, Category E, Form 2. Legibility and reproducibility shall permit conventional making of clearly understandable, high contrast reproductions. Contractors shall submit three copies of final designs as a flat set. Designs shall be submitted for approval as specified in 6.3.5.

6.3.5 Submission of contractor designs.- All submitted designs shall contain a reference to the applicable five digit Code Number contained in Section 4 of this specification and the appropriate component or assembly drawing number and revision letter to which the specific design applies. Unless otherwise specified on the EL, all designs of equipment for inspection of defects classified as critical and major shall be submitted for approval to the Commanding Officer, Picatinny Arsenal, ATTN: SMUPA-ND1. All other designs of inspection equipment shall be approved by the inspection element of the agency administering the contract; submission shall be as directed by the contracting officer. Partial submission of inspection equipment designs is permissible and encouraged. However, the Arsenal completion date for design review will be based on the date of the final submission of designs. Picatinny Arsenal design review will be accomplished normally within one month after receipt.

Custodian:
Army-MU

Preparing activity:
Army-MU

Project Number: 1375-A-1084

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PICATINNY ARSENAL
DOVER, NEW JERSEY 07801

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2. COMMENTS ON ANY SPECIFICATION REQUIREMENT CONSIDERED TOO RIGID

3. IS THE SPECIFICATION RESTRICTIVE?

☐ YES ☐ NO IF "YES", IN WHAT WAY?

4. REMARKS *(Attach any pertinent data which may be of use in improving this specification. If there are additional papers, attach to form and place both in an envelope addressed to preparing activity)*

SUBMITTED BY *(Printed or typed name and activity)*	DATE

DD FORM 1 OCT 64 1426

SPECIFICATION ANALYSIS SHEET

Form Approved
Budget Bureau No. 119-R004

INSTRUCTIONS

This sheet is to be filled out by personnel either Government or contractor, involved in the use of the specification in procurement of products for ultimate use by the Department of Defense. This sheet is provided for obtaining information on the use of this specification which will insure that suitable products can be procured with a minimum amount of delay and at the least cost. Comments and the return of this form will be appreciated. Fold on lines on reverse side, staple in corner, and send to preparing activity.

SPECIFICATION

ORGANIZATION	CITY AND STATE

CONTRACT NO.	QUANTITY OF ITEMS PROCURED	DOLLAR AMOUNT
		$

MATERIAL PROCURED UNDER A

☐ DIRECT GOVERNMENT CONTRACT ☐ SUBCONTRACT

1. HAS ANY PART OF THE SPECIFICATION CREATED PROBLEMS OR REQUIRED INTERPRETATION IN PROCUREMENT USE?

A. GIVE PARAGRAPH NUMBER AND WORDING.

B. RECOMMENDATIONS FOR CORRECTING THE DEFICIENCIES

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